POD POLARIS GROUP

CAPSTONE PROJECT
(BUSINESS CASE AND SDLC)

BUSINESS CASE

for

HR Process Optimization at Synergy Enterprises

Business Analysis January 2026 Cohort

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Business Case: HR Process Optimization at Synergy Enterprises

Synergy Enterprises recommends implementing a unified, cloud-based Global Human Capital Management (HCM) platform to replace the fragmented, region-specific HR systems currently used across its 75,000+ employees on five continents. The investment totals an estimated $20.68M over three years and is projected to deliver $15.6M in net present value, a payback period of approximately 19 months post go-live, and a 3-year ROI of roughly 75%.

Problem Statement

Synergy Enterprises' fragmented HR technology and processes are creating challenges that hinder operational efficiency, strategic decision-making, and employee experience across its global operations:

- **Fragmented employee data.** Information is scattered across legacy and regional systems, causing redundancy and preventing a single global view of the workforce.
- **Inefficient HR operations.** Manual and semi-automated processes (onboarding, reviews, reconciliation) create administrative overhead and errors, crowding out strategic HR work.
- **Lack of global HR insights.** Inconsistent data prevents reliable global reporting on workforce demographics, talent, and diversity, weakening strategic workforce planning.
- **Inconsistent employee experience.** HR processes vary by location, frustrating employees and weakening the global employer brand.
- **Compliance and risk exposure.** Managing diverse global labor laws and data privacy requirements is complex and risky across fragmented systems.
- **High IT maintenance cost.** Maintaining many parallel HR systems consumes significant IT resources and budget that could fund higher-value work.

Objectives

- Standardize HR processes globally to ensure consistency and compliance.

- Implement a unified HCM platform consolidating recruitment, onboarding, payroll, performance, learning, and workforce planning.
- Improve data accuracy and reporting through a single source of truth.
- Enhance the employee and manager experience with modern self-service tools.
- Reduce HR operational costs through automation and system consolidation.
- Enable strategic workforce planning with real-time analytics and KPI tracking.

Scope, Assumptions & Constraints

In scope: global implementation of a cloud-based HCM platform; standardization of core HR processes (hire to retire); integration with payroll, finance, and existing ERP systems; migration of employee data from legacy systems; change management, training, and communication; decommissioning of redundant HR systems.

Out of scope: redesign of compensation structures or job architecture; changes to organizational hierarchy or reporting lines; payroll system replacement (unless required for integration); non-HR systems (e.g., supply chain, manufacturing, CRM).

Assumptions:

- Executive leadership will support global process standardization.
- All regions will adopt the new HCM platform with minimal customization.
- Cloud infrastructure will comply with global data privacy regulations.
- Adequate budget and resources will be allocated for implementation.

Constraints:

- Regional legal and compliance requirements may limit full standardization.
- Data migration complexity due to inconsistent legacy systems.
- Potential resistance to change from local HR teams.
- Implementation timeline may be affected by global time zone differences.

Options Considered

Three paths were assessed against Synergy's objectives. A unified global HCM platform is recommended.

Option	Advantages	Disadvantages	Assessment
Maintain current systems (do nothing)	No upfront investment; minimal disruption	Continued inefficiencies; compliance risk; poor employee experience; cannot scale	Not sustainable for long-term competitive advantage
Upgrade existing regional systems	Reduces change impact; preserves local autonomy	Does not fix system fragmentation; limits global reporting; higher long-term cost	Partial benefit, but not aligned with the global strategy
Implement a unified global HCM platform (recommended)	Single source of truth; standardized global processes; improved compliance and reporting; better employee experience; lower long-term operating cost	Short-term organizational disruption; upfront investment	Enables long-term business growth

Financial Analysis

Estimated cost (USD)

Cost Category	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
HCM software licensing	1,800,000	2,200,000	2,200,000
Implementation & SI partner fees	4,500,000	2,000,000	500,000
Internal programme resources	1,200,000	900,000	400,000
Data migration & cleansing	800,000	300,000	0
Change management & training	600,000	400,000	200,000

Cost Category	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Infrastructure & integration	500,000	200,000	100,000
Contingency (10%)	940,000	600,000	340,000
Total investment	**10,340,000**	**6,600,000**	**3,740,000**

Estimated benefits (USD)

Benefit Category	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
HR headcount reduction / redeployment	500,000	2,200,000	3,800,000
Reduced system maintenance & licence costs	800,000	2,000,000	2,400,000
Productivity gains (self-service automation)	300,000	900,000	1,800,000
Reduced recruitment agency fees	200,000	600,000	1,200,000
Compliance & risk cost avoidance	500,000	750,000	1,000,000
Improved retention (reduced attrition cost)	200,000	600,000	1,200,000
Total annual benefits	**2,500,000**	**7,050,000**	**11,400,000**

Key financial metrics

Metric	Value
Net Present Value (NPV)	USD 15,600,000
Return on Investment (3-yr ROI)	~75%
Payback Period	~19 months post go-live
Internal Rate of Return (IRR)	~42%
Annual Run-Rate Savings (Year 3+)	USD 11,400,000

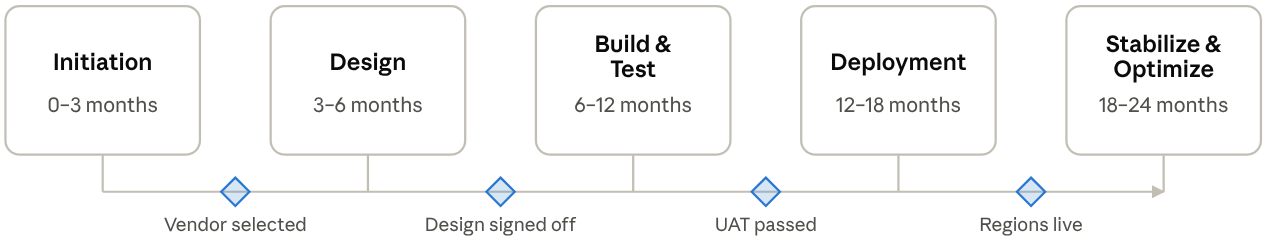
Benefits overtake annual cost during Year 2 and the programme is cash-positive on a cumulative basis by month 19 post go-live, driven mainly by headcount redeployment and licence consolidation as legacy systems are decommissioned.

Risk

Risk	Impact	Mitigation
Resistance to change	High	Strong change management and stakeholder engagement
Data migration errors	Medium	Rigorous testing; phased migration
Integration challenges	Medium	Use experienced implementation partners
Compliance concerns	High	Ensure the platform meets global data privacy standards
Cost overruns	Medium	Clear governance and scope control

Implementation Roadmap

Five phases, four gates, 24 months to go-live



five-phase rollout timeline · 4 gates · 24 months

The programme runs 24 months end to end, gated by four sign-offs: vendor selection, design approval, UAT, and full regional go-live.

Phase	Duration	Key Activities
Initiation	0–3 months	Establish project governance; detailed requirements gathering; select HCM vendor
Design	3–6 months	Define global HR process standards; develop integration architecture; create data migration strategy

Phase	Duration	Key Activities
Build & Test	6–12 months	Configure HCM modules; integrate with payroll and ERP; conduct user acceptance testing
Deployment	12–18 months	Phased regional rollout; deliver training and communication; migrate data and go live
Stabilization & Optimization	18–24 months	Monitor adoption and performance; optimize workflows; decommission legacy systems

SDLC Methodology

A **hybrid (Water-Scrum-Fall) methodology** is recommended: Waterfall-style phase gates govern the overall programme, while Agile/Scrum sprints run inside the Build & Test and Deployment phases.

Why not pure Waterfall. The five-phase, 24-month plan above is sequential and gate-controlled, which suits Waterfall at the programme level. But this is a $10.3M Year-1 investment going to a global board, with data migration complexity across inconsistent legacy systems (named explicitly as a constraint) and five continents of regional variation. Locking requirements at the end of Design and not revisiting them until UAT, as pure Waterfall would require, raises the risk of discovering region-specific gaps only after Build is complete — exactly the kind of late, expensive rework this business case is trying to eliminate.

Why not pure Agile/Scrum. This is a COTS platform configuration (not ground-up custom development), governed by a fixed board-approved budget, a vendor contract, and compliance sign-offs that must happen at defined points. A pure Scrum approach, with no fixed upfront scope or plan, is difficult to govern against a three-year capital budget and makes it hard to give the board the fixed milestones and gate approvals this kind of investment requires.

Why hybrid fits this project specifically:

Need	Waterfall layer	Agile/Scrum layer
Board governance & budget control	Fixed phase gates (Initiation → Design → Build & Test → Deployment → Stabilization), each with a sign-off	—

Need	Waterfall layer	Agile/Scrum layer
Vendor contract & compliance milestones	Locked at Design sign-off and UAT gates	—
Configuration of HCM modules	—	2–3 week sprints per module, with regional HR as product owners
Regional rollout (5 continents)	Deployment phase boundary fixed in the roadmap	Each region's go-live run as its own sprint cycle, so lessons from Region 1 improve Region 2
Data migration risk	Migration strategy fixed at Design	Migrated and validated in iterative batches, tested each sprint, not in one big-bang cutover
Change resistance from local HR teams	—	Regional teams see working configurations early and give feedback before go-live, rather than only at final UAT

This is the same pattern used by major HCM/ERP vendors for global rollouts (SAP Activate, Oracle OUM, Workday's own deployment methodology all combine phase-gated governance with iterative configuration sprints), so it is also the model Synergy's implementation partner will most likely already be equipped to run.

Recommendation: retain the five-phase, gated structure in the Implementation Roadmap above for board governance and budget release, and run Agile/Scrum sprints inside Build & Test and Deployment for configuration, data migration, and the phased regional rollout.

Conclusion & Recommendation

Synergy Enterprises' fragmented HR systems are limiting efficiency, increasing cost, and weakening its ability to compete globally. A unified global HCM platform, delivered through a hybrid Waterfall-governed, Agile-executed programme, will standardize processes, improve data accuracy, and enhance employee experience — positioning HR as a strategic driver of growth.

With strong financial returns (USD 15.6M NPV, ~75% 3-year ROI, ~19-month payback) and a governance model suited to both board oversight and the realities of a 5-continent rollout, this transformation is recommended for approval, with rollout beginning Q3 2026.

Approval

Role	Name	Signature	Date
CEO			
Project Manager			